

[Supplemental] SQL query terms

Previously, you learned that SQL is a programming language that enables data analysts to interact with relational databases. There are many SQL commands, functions, clauses, and operators that data analysts can use to find, add, and manipulate data.

In this reading, you'll find definitions for some key SQL commands, functions, clauses, and operators that you can use to interact effectively with data in relational databases. You can download or print this reading to reference the SQL terms as you work through the certificate program.

SQL key terms

ADD: Inserts a new column into a designated table

AND: Filters data to provide results that meet more than one condition

COUNT: Identifies the number of rows that meet specified criterion

FROM: Specifies what table a query should reference

FULL JOIN: Merges all rows from two tables to create a new table when either table meets specified criteria

GROUP BY: Groups rows that contain the same value for a specified column into summary rows

HAVING: Filters data to return only results that meet a designated aggregate criteria

INNER JOIN: Merges two tables, but only the rows that have matching values in both tables

LEFT JOIN: Merges all the rows from the table to the left of (before) the join clause, but only the rows that match from the table to the right of (after) the join clause

LIKE: Returns results that include a specified pattern within a column

LIMIT: Sets a maximum number of results that a query can return

MAX: Returns the maximum value for a designated column

MIN: Returns the minimum value for a designated column

NOT: Returns results that don't meet a specified criteria

ORDER BY: Sorts data in a designated order, either ascending or descending

OR: Filters data to return results when one of multiple conditions is met

RIGHT JOIN: Merges all the rows from the table to the right of the join clause, but only the rows that match from the table to the left of the join clause

SELECT: Identifies what columns to pull data from in a database

SELECT DISTINCT: Returns only distinct results, and removes duplicates

SUM: Calculates the sum of numeric data in a specified column

UNION: Merges results from multiple select statements, while removing duplicates

WHERE: Filters data to return only results that meet a designated condition